presumably one of the principal *foci* of this particular work more broadly (see Chapter 1), nevertheless mentioned very few specifics regarding the locales where the Firuzkuh Shansabanis resided or brought under their sway. To wit, the continuing search for the winter "capital" of Zamindawar was discussed in Chapter 2, while the descriptive vagaries pertaining to Firuzkuh itself, and the resulting debates surrounding its identification as the Shansabani summer "capital," have been addressed in Chapter 3 and elsewhere.

Juzjani also made no mention of Chisht, about 150 km east of Herat, where two domed structures are what remain of probably another important complex, which originally had an extensive program of cursive and Kufic inscriptions, three of which referred to Shansabani rule (Figures 4.12–4.15, 4.17).[7] Remnants of the cursive inscription on the interior of the better preserved southern structure (Figure 4.12 [left structure], 4.13, and 4.14), ringing the base of its dome, named Shams al-Dunya wa al-Din, presumably a reference to Sultan Ghiyath al-Din, "in [whose] days the renovation (*tajdid*) of this building was ordered" (Figure 4.14); the Kufic inscription ending on the east interior wall (Figure 4.15) lists the date of 10 Jumada al-Awwal 562 AH, or 7 March 1167 CE, which, it should be noted, would render anachronistic the use of the sultan's non-regnal *laqab* (discussed below).[8]

One partial exception to *Tabaqat*'s overall laxity regarding locations and their descriptions (cf. Chapter 2) was the region of Gharjistan, northwest of historical Ghur, which entered Juzjani's narrative multiple times: according to the author, shortly after Qutb al-Din's departure for Ghazna, his brother Baha' al-Din (d. 1149) struck an alliance with the Shars of Gharjistan during the early days of Shansabani ascendancy at Firuzkuh, allowing the reinforcement of Ghur's defenses *via* the construction of new fortifications there and elsewhere. After Baha' al-Din's death, 'Ala' al-Din Husain *Jahan-suz* called up forces from Gharjistan in AH 545/1150 CE as he prepared for his momentous confrontation with Bahram Shah of Ghazna on the plains of Zamindawar (cf. Chapter 1). 'Ala' al-Din Husain further cemented the Firuzkuh–Gharjistan alliance by marrying Hurr Malika, the daughter of Shar Ibrahim ibn Ardashir.[9] It would appear that Shansabani presence in Gharjistan – and quite possibly the alliance between the two ruling houses – continued through the 1160s–1170s. At this time, there was a *madrasa* at Afshin – an unmapped locality, which Juzjani incidentally noted as the capital of the Gharjistan Shars.[10] The *madrasa*'s importance lay in its presiding head being the prominent Karrami Imam Sadr al-Din Ali Haisam of Nishapur.[11]

Also dating to this period is the foundation inscription of Shah-i Mashhad, which unequivocally indicates that a female patron – presumably Taj al-Harir Jauhar Malik, wife of Sultan Ghiyath al-Din – commissioned the magnificent complex (Figures 4.1 and 4.7).[12] While Shah-i Mashhad's